

← Case report for event ID: 1015

ID	Alert rule	Description	Incident type	Severity level	Date and time detected
1015	Suspicious Parent Child Relationship	A suspicious process with an uncommon parent-child relationship was detected in your environment.	Process	Low	Dec 27th 2025 at 23:49

Alert details

Incident report

Edit report

Incident classification

☒ True positive

☐ False positive

Case report

Please write a detailed report on the steps taken to analyse and contain this incident, including all relevant information and the rationale for its closure.

- Time of Incident: 12/27/2025 15:47:23.164

- User Involved: According to Company Information > Directory:
Name: Yami Zubair
Email: yami.zubair@tryhatme.com
Role: IT

- Device: win-3449 (Windows host)

- Incident Details: At 12/27/2025 15:47:23.164, a process creation event was logged where TrustedInstaller.exe (PID 3535) was launched with parent process services.exe (PID 3965). The process executed from "C:\Windows\system32\TrustedInstaller.exe" with working directory "C:\Windows\system32\". The activity was flagged due to an uncommon parent-child process relationship.
Malware identified: None identified.

Additional investigation:

- Additional info:
 - Parent Process: "services.exe" is the Windows Service Control Manager responsible for starting and managing system services.
 - Child Process: "TrustedInstaller.exe" is the Windows Modules Installer used to install, modify, and remove Windows updates and protected system components.

Does this alert require escalation?

☒ Yes

☐ No

Save and close alert.

- Alert 1016: Process
- Identified as True Positive
 - Requires escalation to L2
 - Full Report Documented on the last page

splunk>enterprise

Apps

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Save As Create Table View Close

1 host.name="win-3456" process.name="taskhostw.exe" 6 day window

1 of 5 events matched No Event Sampling

Events Patterns Statistics Visualization

Format Timeline Zoom Out Zoom to Selection Deselect 1 hour per column

List Format 50 Per Page

< Hide Fields All Fields

SELECTED FIELDS

a host 1

a source 1

a sourcetype 1

INTERESTING FIELDS

a datasource 1

a event.action 1

event.code 1

a host.name 1

a index 1

linecount 1

a process.command_line 1

a process.name 1

process.parent.name 1

process.parent.pid 1

process.pid 1

a process.working_directory 1

a punct 1

a splunk_server 1

a timestamp 1

+ Extract New Fields

i Time Event

> 12/27/25 3:48:36.248 PM { [-]

datasource: sysmon

event.action: Process Create (rule: ProcessCreate)

event.code: 1

host.name: win-3456

process.command_line: taskhostw.exe NGCKeyPregen

process.name: taskhostw.exe

process.parent.name: svchost.exe

process.parent.pid: 3601

process.pid: 3756

process.working_directory: C:\Windows\system32\

timestamp: 12/27/2025 15:48:36.248

} Show as raw text

host = 10.10.178.106:8989 | source = eventcollector | sourcetype = _json

SIEM Investigation

- The incident only happened once in the last 6 hours (Starting Dec 27th 2025 at 15:20 to 21:20)

Submitted report:

- Time of Incident: 12/27/2025 15:47:23.164

- User Involved: According to Company Information > Directory

Name: Safa Prince

Email: safa.prince@tryhatme.com

Role: Sales

Logged-in Host: win-3456

- Device: win-3456 (Windows host)

- Incident Details: At 12/27/2025 15:47:23.164, a process creation event was logged where taskhostw.exe (PID 3756) was launched with parent process svchost.exe (PID 3601). The process executed with command line `taskhostw.exe NGCKeyPregen` from `C:\Windows\system32\`. The activity was flagged due to an uncommon parent-child process relationship.

- Malware Identified: None identified.

- Additional Investigation:

Additional info:

- Parent Process: `svchost.exe` is a Windows service host process responsible for running background system services implemented as DLLs.

- Child Process: `taskhostw.exe` is used to execute Windows background tasks. The `NGCKeyPregen` parameter is associated with Windows Hello and credential key pre-generation activities.

- Why This Is Uncommon: `taskhostw.exe` is typically launched by the Task Scheduler or user session processes during authentication workflows. Direct execution by `svchost.exe` is less frequently observed and should be validated to ensure it aligns with legitimate Windows Hello or credential management activity.

- Recommendations: Escalate to Level 2 (L2) for further investigation and handling.

- This is a True Positive

- This needs escalation to L2 for further investigation